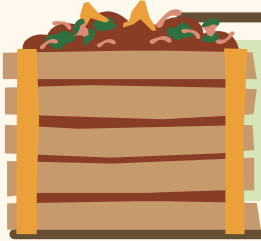
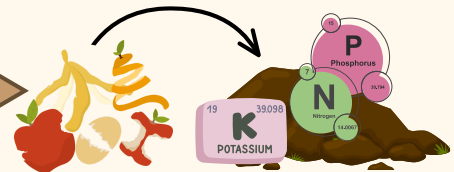


# VERMICOMPOSTING



**Vermicomposting** is the process of breaking down *organic waste* (food scraps) using red wiggler worms.

## WHY VERMICOMPOST?



Worms eat the organic matter and produce **worm castings** (worm poop). These castings are rich in **nutrients** like *nitrogen*, *phosphorus*, and *potassium*, making them excellent fertilizers to use for your garden!

## HOW TO VERMICOMPOST



### STEP 1: PREPARE BIN & BEDDING

1. Drill/poke holes in the top of your bin for **ventilation**.



2. Shred cardboard and newspaper and soak in water.

3. Fill ~3/4 of the bin volume with damp paper mixed with a bit of garden soil.

### STEP 2: ADD WORMS

Add worms to your bin! We recommend red wigglers, but other types can also be used.



### STEP 3: ADD FOOD WASTE

Now, it's time to add your organic materials! Don't add too much at once, start off small.



### MATERIALS

1. An opaque plastic container with a lid.



2. Shredded cardboard or scrunched-up paper for the bedding.



3. Red wiggler worms!



# TIPS FOR STARTING YOUR BIN

## FOR BEDDING...

- Worms love moisture, so keep their bedding (shredded cardboard, paper, and garden soil) damp, almost dripping water, but not quite.
- Avoid glossy magazines, bleached white office paper, and coloured prints. Use soy-inked newsprint, shredded cardboard, and scrunched-up brown paper.



## WHAT TO PUT IN YOUR BIN?

### LIMIT:

Starches like bread and potatoes.



### AVOID:

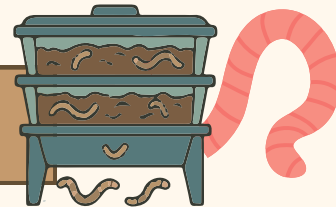
Meat, dairy, fatty, oily, or fermented products.



### WORMS LOVE:

Banana peels, bell pepper tops, and soft avocado scraps.

**TIP** If you have a lot of food scraps, you can store them in the freezer to add later!



## BIN MAINTENANCE

Maintaining your bin is easy because worms like as little disturbance as possible!

Put your bin in a cool, dark place away from extreme temperatures, keep the bedding moist, and adjust how much food you give your worms based on how much they eat.

In 2–3 months, worm castings will start to form and can be used as fertilizer.



## IN A THRIVING BIN YOU WILL SEE...



**Clumping:** worms gather together in a big ball around a favourite piece of food.



Lots of worm poop!

(University of Saskatchewan, 2023) Vermicomposting (indoor method). / (Carr, R. 2016) Vermicomposting for beginners. / (Urban Worm Company, 2027) Can you use worms you find in your garden for vermicompost?

# VERMICOMPOSTING QUIZ

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS BASED ON VERMICOMPOSTING 101

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## 1. WHAT WORMS SHOULD YOU USE AND WHY?

- **Red wrigglers!** You can't use regular earthworms because they don't reproduce well in small/confined spaces, and they don't go through organic material efficiently.
- You can also use European Nightcrawlers, African Nightcrawlers, Indian Blue Worms!

## 2. WHAT ARE THE BENEFITS OF VERMICOMPOSTING?

Building a **circular food system** by composting and creating **nutrient** (*potassium, nitrogen, and phosphorus*) **rich fertilizers** for your garden!

## 3. WHEN WILL YOU START SEEING WORM CASTINGS?

After 2-3 months!

## 4. WHAT ARE SIGNS OF A HAPPY BIN?

1. Worm clumping
2. Lots of **worm castings** (poop)!

### TRUE OR FALSE:

**You should check on your worms several times a day | FALSE**

- Worm bins benefit from as little disturbance as possible.

**You should keep your soil as moist as possible | TRUE**

- The soil should feel like it's dripping with moisture.

**The bin should be stored in a place with lots of sunlight | FALSE**

- Your bin should be stored in a cool, dark place, away from temperature fluctuations.

# VERMICOMPOSTING QUIZ

## QUESTIONS ONLY

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1. What worms should you use and why?

2. What are the benefits of vermicomposting?

3. When will you start seeing worm castings?

4. What are signs of a happy bin?

### TRUE OR FALSE:

You should check on your worms several times a day

• Why? \_\_\_\_\_

T/F

You should keep your soil as moist as possible

• Why? \_\_\_\_\_

T/F

Your bin should be stored in a location with lots of sunlight

• Why? \_\_\_\_\_

T/F

**BONUS:** What would you name your worms?

# VERMICOMPOST GLOSSARY

## **VERMICOMPOSTING**

The process of breaking down organic waste using adorable worms.

## **VERMICOMPOST BIN**

A container with bedding and worms transforming organic waste into worm castings.

## **CIRCULAR FOOD SYSTEM**

A sustainable food system where any waste products are re-used.

## **FERTILIZER**

A nutrient-rich substance added to plants or gardens to improve growth.

## **NUTRIENTS**

Chemical substances (in food) that humans, plants, and animals need to grow.

## **ORGANIC WASTE**

Waste materials from living things that naturally break down (like food scraps).

## **RED WRIGGLER WORMS**

Worms used for vermicomposting. Eat efficiently and reproduce in small spaces.

## **VENTILATION**

Allowing new air to come in to improve air quality (in this case for the worms).

## **WORM CASTINGS**

Another word for *worm poop*, castings are the primary product of vermicomposting and can be used as fertilizer!

## **WORM CLUMPING**

When worms gather together in a big ball around a favourite piece of food. We like to call it a ***bundle of joy***.